

being issued to. Fortunately, once the blockchain is live, because it's a distributed and transparent ledger, it's easy to see address balances. Often there are sites that will show the amount held by the top addresses, such as the Bitcoin Rich List.⁴⁶ For Bitcoin, two addresses hold between them 227,618 bitcoin, or roughly 1.4 percent of the total outstanding. Another 116 addresses hold a total of 2.87 million bitcoin, or 19 percent of the total outstanding, which is sizeable. Unlike dash, however, these holders aren't necessarily receiving nearly half of the newly minted bitcoin, and so their ability to push the price upward is less. Lastly, it should be noted that a single person can have multiple bitcoin addresses, so each address is not necessarily a distinct entity.

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In closing, there are many tricks of the trade, whether it be mass speculation, misleading asset issuers, Ponzi finance, or cornering, with much of it justified by "this time is different" thinking. However, these are not new tricks—they have existed for centuries and in all asset classes. The best way for innovative investors to avoid these traps when considering cryptoassets for their portfolio is to perform proper due diligence on the fundamentals and ignore the whims of the crowd. Understanding which fundamentals are most important for long-term growth takes us to the next chapter on a framework for investigating cryptoassets.

